MOST IMPROVED BIG STATES INFRASTRUCTURE

RANK 2022	STATE	SCORE OUT OF 280	RANK 2021
1	JHARKHAND	220.6	1
2	MADHYA PRADESH	210.1	3
3	BIHAR	186.1	2
4	RAJASTHAN	175.6	5
5	TELANGANA	169.6	4
6	ANDHRA PRADESH	168.1	9
7	ASSAM	165.3	10
8	UTTAR PRADESH	152.6	13
9	CHHATTISGARH	152.4	8
10	ODISHA	149.5	7
11	MAHARASHTRA	141.3	12
12	GUJARAT	134.1	14
13	HIMACHAL PRADESH	130.7	16
14	PUNJAB	117.5	15
15	HARYANA	116.4	11
16	UTTARAKHAND	115.6	6
17	TAMIL NADU	103.6	17
18	WEST BENGAL	103.2	20
19	KERALA	102.9	19
20	KARNATAKA	100.5	18

MOST IMPROVED SMALL STATES INFRASTRUCTURE

RANK 2022	STATE	SCORE OUT OF 280	RANK 2021
1	MANIPUR	190.6	2
2	ARUNACHAL PRADESH	185.3	1
3	MIZORAM	170.2	7
4	NAGALAND	149.0	4
5	MEGHALAYA	144.8	3
6	TRIPURA	133.7	6
7	SIKKIM	130.5	10
8	GOA	122.0	5
9	PUDUCHERRY	118.9	8
10	DELHI	112.1	9

Roads connecting Imphal with Jiribam and Kohima have been double-laned. Construction of five national highways, with a length of over 110 km, will start soon. Chief Minister N. Biren Singh attributes all this to the Union government's focus on the Northeast. "Before Jal Jeevan Mission was launched, the Modi government sanctioned Rs 3,500 crore for Manipur for building the infrastructure to supply drinking water," says Singh. Several of the 62 sports infrastructure projects in the Northeast under the Khelo India scheme are in Manipur. To boost mobile connectivity, the PM dedicated 2,387 mobile towers to Manipuris earlier this year. ■

–Anilesh S. Mahajan, Kaushik Deka and Amitabh Srivastava

CATEGORY WINNERS

AGRICULTURE

ROOTED TO THE SOIL

Punjab's ploughs still hold their own but others are focusing on innovation and farmer-centric schemes to make the fields bloom



Punjab continues its dominance in agriculture in India, but questions are being raised on its agri model, especially its inability to move from a monocrop culture focusing on water-intensive crops. Meanwhile, two states in the south, Telangana and Puducherry, are betting on innovation and farm-centric schemes to boost agriculture output and improve the lot of their farmers. This has also helped them move to the top of the rankings, having done admirably in many of the criteria such as contribution of agriculture to GDP, agriculture GSDP/ rural population and percentage of irrigated land.

Best Performing Big State: Punjab

The country's largest wheat grower is on track to produce enough to fill buffer stocks this year too. The state has already completed sowing on farms spread over 2.9 million